

FARUK BUĞRA KOCA

Senior Product Manager · Fintech · Payments · Crypto · AI-Enabled Products

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Manager with 10+ years in fintech across Turkey, the UK, and the UAE. Owned mobile banking products at ~4M-user scale, led one of the national pilot integrations of Turkey's instant payment system (FAST), and built two products from zero — a digital wallet that later launched as a licensed bank app, and a B2B crypto-to-fiat settlement platform. Has shipped AI into production three times over: NLP chatbot flows, an AI merchant-support agent, and AI fraud detection. Equally comfortable leading a 45-person delivery organisation and running a lean vendor-built platform, with legal, compliance, and risk in the room throughout.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Leadership: End-to-end product strategy, greenfield (0-to-1) launches, continuous discovery, OKRs, roadmap ownership, prioritisation

Fintech Domains: Mobile & internet banking, digital wallets, instant payments (FAST), B2B crypto payments, crypto-to-fiat settlement, digital KYC & onboarding, e-money licensing

AI in Product: NLP chatbot design and intent mapping, AI-driven support automation, AI fraud-detection integration, voice interfaces, generative content pipelines

Data & Technical: SQL, funnel and cohort analysis, A/B testing and experimentation, API integration (Postman, Swagger), Firebase, Google Analytics

Governance & Risk: Regulatory compliance (CBRT/BRSA, Swiss and UK frameworks), AML/KYC, licensing workflows, legal and risk stakeholder alignment

Ways of Working: Scrum, dual-track agile, Jira, Azure DevOps, Figma, Miro, Zeplin

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Break

Jun 2025 – Present

- Actively seeking a senior product management role in fintech.

Product Manager, Criex — Papel Holding (Dubai, UAE)

Oct 2024 – May 2025

- Owned product for Criex, a B2B crypto payment infrastructure providing crypto-to-fiat settlement for merchants operating across Dubai, the UK, Singapore, Malta, and Cyprus.
- Structured the end-to-end operational and business flows required for international crypto licensing (Swiss), translating legal and regulatory requirements into product specifications and internal process design.
- Directed two external vendor companies reporting into the role, running integrations with liquidity providers, digital wallet custodians, and AI-powered fraud detection.
- Defined merchant onboarding, conversion, and payout reconciliation flows for the platform's launch merchants.

Senior Product Manager (Remote) — Bitpace (United Kingdom)

Dec 2021 – Oct 2024

- Led product for a B2B crypto payment platform, managing a 12-person distributed team across engineering, operations, and compliance.
- Ran analytical discovery with SQL and cohort analysis to locate friction in the merchant journey, driving a 20% increase in merchant retention.
- Delivered USDT TRC-20 and multi-network payment support under tight deadlines, preventing churn among enterprise clients representing 10% of total platform revenue.
- Drove discovery and delivery of an AI-driven chatbot that automated merchant support and shortened B2B troubleshooting workflows.
- Owned the merchant panel and back-office roadmap end to end, from discovery through release.

Product Owner — TOM Bank (Turkey)

Apr 2021 – Oct 2021

- Lead Product Owner on the zero-to-one build of TOM Wallet, scoped as an e-money wallet ahead of licensing; the product later launched publicly as HADİ once the bank secured its e-money and banking licences.
- Defined core business logic, infrastructure requirements, and the initial product roadmap from a blank page.
- Directed two external vendor companies reporting into the role, working alongside legal and compliance to shape payment and credit features against Turkish banking regulation.

Product Owner, CEPTETEB Mobile App — Turkish Economy Bank (TEB)

Jan 2020 – Apr 2021

- Led TEB's pilot integration of FAST, Turkey's 24/7 instant payment system, as one of the banks selected by the Central Bank for the pilot — making real-time transfers available to the full CEPTETEB base of ~2M users.
- Owned end-to-end delivery of an in-house digital KYC solution that removed ~90% of manual onboarding workload: a single ID-and-photo capture replaced paper forms, wet signatures, and manual account opening.
- Rebuilt the Expense Analysis module around bar and bubble visualisations, simplifying spend tracking for the same ~2M user base.
- One of three Product Owners across three squads (~45 people) plus an outsourced delivery partner; used funnel analysis, A/B testing, and experimentation to steer decisions.

Product Owner (VP title), Internet & Mobile Banking — DenizBank (Turkey)

Apr 2016 – Jun 2019

- Product owner for MobilDeniz (~4M active users), leading its full redesign and relaunch on lean product principles; one of three Product Owners across three squads of ~45 people.
- Shipped Turkey's first voice-activated ATM withdrawal (fastPay, via Sestek integration), before Turkish was supported on iOS Siri.
- Delivered Istanbulkart top-up inside mobile banking — a market first, adopted by ~20% of Istanbul-based customers.
- Designed NLP chatbot workflows within MobilDeniz, owning intent mapping and algorithm testing for automated customer resolution.
- Built voice-command accessibility features for visually impaired users, validated through psychometric and A/B testing.
- Worked directly with C-level on strategic product direction, and with Legal, Compliance, and Risk on regulatory alignment across releases.

Senior Business Analyst — Intertech (Turkey)

Feb 2015 – Apr 2016

- Led analysis for Kumsal, an SME SaaS platform covering website creation, basic accounting, CRM, and communication modules — moving into client-side product leadership at DenizBank on the strength of the work.

Earlier Experience

2010 – 2014

- Project Manager, Haser Software (2013–2014) · Founder, Mergen Consulting (2012–2013) · Material Manager, Netmon (2010–2011).

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Finalist — EFMA & Accenture Innovation Awards and BAI Global Innovation Awards, for the Kumsal SME ecosystem.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

BSc, Industrial Engineering — Osmangazi University

Associate Degree, Logistics Management — Anadolu University

Languages: Turkish (native) · English (C1, professional working proficiency)